

Victor Nordgaard

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Research Profile

Ph.D. fellow at the Department of Political Science at Aarhus University. My dissertation, “*Unequal Democracy and the Inconspicuous Nature of Representation*,” examines unequal political representation and combines research on inequality, public opinion, elite perceptions and political mobilization. I have a strong methodological profile, with expertise in quantitative methods, causal inference, survey experiments, and natural language processing (NLP). I also have experience with qualitative elite interviews.

Experience

Ph.D. Student

Feb. 2024 – present

Department of Political Science, Aarhus University

Teaching Assistant and Research Assistant

Jan. 2022 – Jan. 2024

Aarhus University

- Teaching Assistant for undergraduate students in the following courses:
 - General Political Science
 - Public Policy
 - Methods II: Quantitative Methods
- Research assistant on a project about political representation and voter behavior.

Project Assistant, Social and Economic Impact

Sep. 2022 – Jan. 2023

Ramboll

Conducted quantitative and qualitative analyses for governmental agencies, foundations, and municipalities, including work on social and economic impact assessments.

Education

Cand.scient.pol., Political Science

Completed Feb. 2026

Aarhus University

Specialization in advanced quantitative methods and social data science, with a focus on political representation and inequality. Completed as part of Ph.D. Grade average: 11.4.

B.A., Political Science

Completed Jun. 2022

Aarhus University

Bachelor's thesis on differences in the representation of income groups' preferences on the political agenda (grade: 12). Grade average: 9.8.

Publications

- Hejstvig-Larsen, V., Kristiansen, E. N. (2024). Forskelsbehandling op til valg? Sammenhængen mellem den elektorale cyklus og deservingness-heuristikken. *Politica*, 56(1), 23–38. <https://doi.org/10.7146/politica.v56i1.142993>.

Working Papers

- Victor Nordgaard “The Anticipatory Filter and the Absence of Redistributive Conflict in Studies of Unequal Responsiveness.”
- Victor Nordgaard “Policy Exposure and Political Representation.”
- Paula Bings & Victor Nordgaard “Imposing the Burden: Income and the Distribution of Public Goods.”
- Victor Nordgaard “The (Perceived) Electoral Cost of Redistribution”

Conference Presentations

- **APSA Annual Meeting, 2026** — “The Anticipatory Filter and the Absence of Redistributive Conflict in Studies of Unequal Responsiveness.” Paper presentation in panel.
- **EPSS, 2026** — “Tangible and Real: How Disengaged Citizens Mobilize When Policy Affects Their Daily Lives.” Paper presentation in panel.
- **DPSA Annual Meeting, 2025** — “How Unequal Representation Mobilizes Disengaged Citizens.” Paper presentation in panel.
- **DPSA Annual Meeting, 2024** — “Two Worlds of Representation: Discovering the Unintuitive Mechanics of Mass Democracy.” Paper presentation in panel. With Martin Bisgaard and Costin Ciobanu.

Teaching

Aarhus University

- General Political Science, third-semester undergraduate students.
- Public Policy, fifth-semester undergraduate students.
- Methods II: Quantitative Methods, second-semester undergraduate students.
- Inequality and Democracy: What Does Income Mean for Political Influence?, Master seminar.

Grants and Awards

Crown Prince Frederik Scholarship

2026

Awarded the Crown Prince Frederik Scholarship to support a research stay at Harvard Kennedy School.

Forthcoming Research Stay

Visiting Scholar

2027

Harvard Kennedy School

Forthcoming research stay.

Academic Service

- Peer reviewer, *Acta Politica* (manuscript review).

Methods and Software

- **Quantitative methods:** causal inference, survey experiments, statistical modelling, quantitative research design, analysis of large-scale datasets.
- **Computational methods:** natural language processing (NLP), text analysis, data processing.
- **Software:** R, Python, Excel.

- **Qualitative methods:** elite interviews, qualitative research design.

Media Appearances

- Kristeligt Dagblad — “Forskere bag ny undersøgelse af valgflæsk advarer om potentielt demokratisk problem”
- Fagbladet 3F — “Valg i år: Sådan kan fødevarechecken flytte stemmer”